CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

MARKET RESEARCHER IN THE AI ERA

Every company is guessing about its customers. Researchers get paid to replace guesses with evidence.

★ TL;DR — ~$75K median for analytical, fully remote work, with 6–12 months to build the skill stack and a credential. The catch: your beautiful analysis still has to survive executives who 'just know'. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

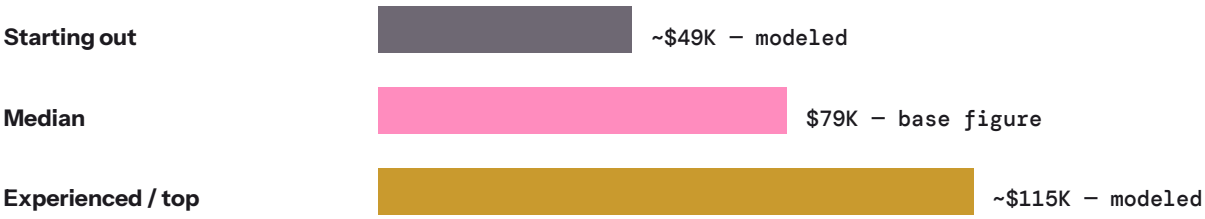
OUR TAKE: YES

MEDIAN ~$79K · TRAINING 6-12 months · AI RISK MEDIUM · CERTIFICATE

- Decisions backed by data beat opinions — companies fund that advantage.
- The work blends statistics, psychology, and storytelling.
- AI crunches data fast, which makes formulating the right question the valuable part.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Market Researcher is a ~$79K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A MARKET RESEARCHER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Design surveys, interviews, and studies
- ✓ Analyze data: segments, trends, willingness to pay

✓ Run competitor and market-size analyses

✓ Present findings as decisions, not just charts

Think: a detective for demand — the clues are in behavior, and nobody confesses directly.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
AI codes open-ended responses, builds charts, and summarizes datasets in minutes. Data cleaning — the old junior grind — is mostly automated.	Choosing what's worth asking, spotting the biased sample, and telling a room its favorite assumption is wrong — that's judgment, and it's the job.

⚠ **Bad research is worse than none: a confident wrong answer steers real money. Your credibility is one sloppy study away from damaged.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Fully remote, quiet, deep-focus work ✓ Low people-load: the data is your main counterpart ✓ Skills port across every industry	✗ Findings get ignored when they're politically inconvenient ✗ Deadline piles around launches and planning cycles ✗ You must sell conclusions to rooms that prefer their instincts

Good fit? You're skeptical, numerate, and genuinely curious why people do what they do.
Bad fit? You want your work to be automatically believed, or statistics feels like a foreign language.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — RESEARCH AGENCY	DOOR B — IN-HOUSE INSIGHTS
Agencies and insights firms run studies for many clients — the reps are unmatched. You'll learn methods on real projects with senior researchers checking your work.	Join a product or marketing team as its research hire. Fewer studies, deeper context, and you watch your findings turn into decisions.

Smart move: Learn SQL and one stats tool alongside survey craft — the researcher who can pull their own data never waits on anyone, and gets hired first.
Where you land after: Senior researcher, insights manager, then research leadership or consultancy.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
BUILD THE	LEARN THE	GET THE	RUN A	GET INSIDE	OWN A

STEP 1 — Build the stats base

FREE–$150 · MONTHS 1–2

- Learn statistics properly: sampling, significance, bias.
- Get fluent in spreadsheets, then add SQL.

STEP 2 — Learn the methods

MONTHS 2–4

- Survey design, interview technique, and basic qualitative coding.
- Study how pricing and concept tests are structured.

STEP 3 — Get the credential

$200–600 · MONTHS 3–6

- Complete a recognized market-research certificate or methods program.
- Add a data-analytics credential if your base is light.

STEP 4 — Run a real study

MONTHS 4–7

- Design and field a small study end to end — even for a tiny client.
- Write the report as decisions and recommendations, not data dumps.

STEP 5 — Get inside a team

PAID · MONTHS 6–10

- Land a junior researcher or insights analyst seat.
- Volunteer for the unglamorous data work — it's where methods become reflexes.

STEP 6 — Own a research question

WORKING · MONTHS 10–12

- Lead a study from brief to boardroom presentation.
- Defend your method under hostile questioning — that's the craft.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: pick your stack — a statistics course plus SQL — and start lesson one.
- □ Days 1–30: stats foundations underway; first survey designed and critiqued.
- □ Days 31–60: a small real study fielded for practice; analysis tools getting fluent.

□ Days 61–90: study written up as a decision report; junior-role applications out.

□ Day 90: you have an end-to-end study in your portfolio — proof, in a field that runs on proof.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **ASK BETTER QUESTIONS.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.